THE PROBLEM EVERYONE IS SOLVING, AND THE ONE THAT ACTUALLY BINDS

At 22, your biggest asset is not money. It is forty years of future earnings: in pesos, tied to one economy, impossible to sell. A young Filipino already depends almost entirely on the Philippines, without ever choosing to.

Then look at what is easy to reach. Pag-IBIG MP2 lends those savings to the Philippine government. Local index funds buy the same economy again: over the past five years, ₱100 in the PSEi became about ₱92. Most low-minimum products are built to park money for the short term, not to grow it over five years or more.

Access is no longer the binding constraint, and we will not pretend it is. BPI cut its UITF minimum from ₱10,000 to ₱1,000 in 2023; some platforms reach ₱50. PSE accounts rose 50.1% in a year, 26.5% of them now held by 18-to-29-year-olds, and the BSP measures financial literacy rising. Young Filipinos are already here. What is missing is a clear place for money with a five-year-plus purpose.

> *"Number one: you have to get global exposure… by diversifying some of that local exposure, you're actually lowering your volatility."* — Joaquin Rossano U. Veluz, Sun Life Investment Management and Trust Co.

THE SECOND ERROR: THE RISK MODEL IS POINTED THE WRONG WAY

The retail risk framework is built to protect a balance, which is right for someone drawing money out. A young saver is doing the opposite: paying in every month. For them, a fall early on means buying more units at a lower price.

The proof is arithmetic. We reordered the fund's own 60 monthly results 20,000 times; the total return stays fixed and only the order changes. Link between a strong first half and the final amount:

Saver paying in ₱1,000 a month	−0.85
Someone drawing out ₱900 a month	+0.85

Same returns, opposite outcomes. **In pesos:** ₱1,000 a month in a money-market fund at 4.5% gives about ₱67,238 after five years; the weakest of all 20,000 orderings of the fund's results still gives about ₱86,176. This is not a claim that falls are good; a fall that never recovers hurts everyone.

WHAT THIS IMPLIES, AND THE FUND IT PRODUCES

The objective changes. Not "minimise the fall", which is the retiree's goal, but **maximise the chance the saver is still contributing in year five**, because contributions decide where they end up. The Hook (page 2) and the Habit (page 3) serve that one number.

The mandate. The proposed Firsts Fund is a peso-denominated, actively managed global equity UITF for goals **five years or more** away (a recommended horizon, not a lock-in). Its theme is **global real capacity**: it invests directly in 31 listed businesses providing essential services and infrastructure that are hard to replace (power and water, phone and internet networks, ports, airports, hospitals, and the equipment behind them), across 14 markets. Technology exposure is assessed, not excluded. No fund-of-funds layer. ₱100 to start; 1.50% a year (proposed).

Chosen by M · V · P, the same published rules for every company:

M · Map the milestone	Essential services a saver's firsts depend on: **140** screened, **129** fit
V · Verify the investment	Debt stress test; value and quality vs peers: **49** pass
P · Position the risk	Sized so no company dominates the risk: **31** held

Holdings reviewed monthly; weights reset quarterly. Full holdings and process: Fund Fact Sheet (pages 4–5).

25.0% vs 10.0%

a year, 5 years: today's holdings (backtested) vs benchmark NFRA

₱372 deepest drop on a ₱5,000 balance (−7.4%)	**₱1,363** 36-year worst 12 months (−27%) on ₱5,000

Every figure in pesos. A first-jobber does not think in percentages, so we show the peso amount beside every risk number. **Read honestly:** the holdings were chosen in 2026 and tested backwards, so 25.0% is the historical performance of the currently selected portfolio, not a forecast. Without chip and grid-equipment makers it is 18.7%; over 36 years the approach earned 12.0% a year, about the world market. Broad indices are market context only.

POSITIONING: MEASURED AGAINST WHAT A YOUNG FILIPINO CAN ACTUALLY BUY TODAY

Product	Structure	Min.	Fee	What it still does not solve
Global fund-of-funds (e.g. BPI Global Equity FoF)	Owns 11 other funds	₱1,000	1.50% + target-fund fees	Layered fees; you cannot see the companies you own.
Philippine equity index fund	Passive, 32 PSEi names	₱1,000	1.50%	More of the one economy the saver already depends on.
Pag-IBIG MP2	Government savings	₱500	None	Tax-free and never negative. Better for a first 3–5 years away; our goal screen points there.
Peso money-market fund / UITF	Short-term debt	₱50–1,000	~0.5–1.0%	Steady, but built for short-term goals.
Firsts Fund (proposed)	31 companies directly	₱100	1.50%, one layer	Global essential services, in pesos, every company named.

A comparison of design (fees, minimum, structure), not of track records: ours is backtested, theirs are live. Sources: BPI Global Equity Fund-of-Funds KIIDS (29 May 2026); BPI Philippine Equity Index Fund KIIDS (30 Jan 2026); Pag-IBIG; PSE investor profile 2024 (via Manila Bulletin, 2025); BPI Wealth; BSP. Shuffle test: the fund's monthly results after costs.

THE MESSAGE

Fund your firsts.

Retirement is the wrong hook for a 22-year-old, and not because they are short-termist. It is forty years away, it belongs to a version of themselves they cannot picture, and every competing product already uses it. **A first is different: it has a name, a peso cost and a date.** It is a long-horizon goal a young Filipino can actually see, and it is why the account never closes: there is always another one. The portfolio supports that promise in the background; how it is built lives in the fact sheet.

Take Mom and Dad abroad	First car	First home
First business	First ₱100,000	Paying for a parent's care

All five years or more away. Each is entered in the app as a peso amount and a date, which turns a feeling into a contribution plan.

WHO IT IS FOR

Graduating students to entry-level professionals preparing for a meaningful long-term first, with regular income and the risk tolerance for a stock fund. A first milestone is not the same as a first investment: not every beginner suits this fund. Professionals further along in their careers can use it too, if their goal is five or more years away.

Meet Bea (illustrative). 23, junior accountant, takes home about **₱28,000 a month**.

Rent and bills · Food · Helping at home · Transport	₱22,000
Emergency savings · Personal	₱4,000
Her first: Japan with her parents in 5 years	**₱2,000**

WHY COMPETENCE AND NOT FOMO: THREE INDEPENDENT LEGS

1 · Behaviour. A survey of 191 Filipino students (Susada, 2025) found that feeling capable (knowledge and confidence) was the strongest driver of intending to invest; pressure from friends and family was not significant. One university, and it measures intention, not behaviour.

2 · The regulator's measurement. BSP records literacy rising: 74% answer at least half the questions correctly, up from 69%. The gap is confidence and product shape, not knowledge.

3 · Where the appetite went. Crypto awareness rose from 6% of adults to 20%, and 46% of Filipino crypto owners are 18–34. The appetite for growth exists; it needs a regulated, long-term home.

What this rules out: raffles, cash rewards, referral bounties, leaderboards, countdown timers and streaks; rewards stay a future idea only if costs and approvals allow. **What it keeps:** a user can share their plan (the first, the cost, the date), never a sign-up bonus.

THE CAMPAIGN: THE GOAL CALCULATOR

The opening asset is a calculator on one screen in the BPI App (proposed): name your first, enter the cost, pick a date at least five years away. Before any commitment it shows, with every assumption visible:

Contributions only	₱120,000 ÷ 60 months = **₱2,000 a month**
Illustrative growth	At an assumed 6% a year, about **₱1,710 a month**; an example, not a promise
Rising prices (optional)	At 4% inflation the trip costs ~₱146,000: ₱2,430 a month, contributions only

Clear, balanced risk information. Bea's plan across every five-year stretch of our 36-year history: typical ₱160,000; 1 in 20 at or below ₱110,000; weakest ₱77,000. Illustrative, not a forecast. The calculator builds competence rather than excitement, and it is what people share.

THE LAUNCH: CHANNELS, AND A CALENDAR ANCHOR

Talks and caravans	On-site financial-literacy talks and campus caravans. The priority channel.
Campus events	Student organisations and graduating classes.
Early-career workplaces	Financial-wellness sessions for new hires, including employers on BPI payroll.
Film and short-form	The graduate-story campaign film and short cuts; creators support, not lead.
BPI App, "Chat with us"	Online visitors can ask a person before starting.

Every channel has one next action: name your first in the goal calculator.

The anchor: launch on the 13th month.
The most predictable cash event in the Filipino year: it lands in December and is money no first-jobber budgeted. *"Your 13th month was never in the budget. Give it a first."* December opens the account; the monthly plan keeps it going.

THE COMMERCIAL QUESTION A ₱100 MINIMUM INVITES

₱100 at 1.50% earns ₱1.50 a year; the economics are in steady contributions. A ₱2,000-a-month plan like Bea's reaches about ₱160,000 in a typical five-year stretch, roughly **₱2,400 a year** in fees. What decides it is how many are still contributing in month 60. Flagged: the fund needs seed capital and a minimum size for custody, currency and audit costs; this is the shape of a cost model, not a costed one.

FIVE FRICTIONS, AND WHAT REMOVES EACH

"I don't have enough"	₱100 to start and per top-up.
"I don't know what I'm buying"	31 named companies. Not a fund of funds.
"I'll lose it"	Clear risk information in pesos before committing.
"I'll need it back"	Goals under five years are pointed to MP2 or a money-market fund.
"I stopped and never restarted"	A missed month prompts a choice; it never closes the plan.

Bea and her budget are illustrative; calculator growth and inflation rates are example assumptions shown to the user. Sources: Susada (2025); BSP Consumer Finance and Inclusion Survey 2025; Triple-A.

THE CUSTOMER JOURNEY: FROM DISCOVERING A FIRST TO NAMING THE NEXT ONE

Stage	Investor's question	Experience and action	Main touchpoints
1 · Discover your first	"I have so many plans. Where do I begin?"	Encounter the graduate-story campaign and connect a personal aspiration with the habit of investing. **Next action: Name your first.**	Campaign film, short-form content, creators, campus activities, workplace financial-literacy sessions
2 · Name your first	"What am I working towards?"	Choose one primary goal from suggestions or enter a custom first. Set its estimated cost and a date at least five years away. Use the calculator to compare contributions alone with an illustrative investment scenario, with assumptions and optional inflation adjustment visible. Check suitability before proceeding.	Goal selection screen, calculator, concise fund overview, risk assessment and disclosures
3 · Take the first step	"How do I begin?"	Complete account opening, select the funding account and contribution schedule, and authorize investments. The optional account-level glide path is explained; users who enroll give standing authorization.	Account-opening flow, contribution setup, glide-path enrollment, plan confirmation
4 · Manage your first	"How is my plan progressing?"	Make scheduled contributions and voluntary top-ups. See total contributions, current value, gain/loss, goal progress and the next contribution. Review the plan when circumstances change.	Goal dashboard, contribution confirmations, payday reminders, periodic summaries, allocation view, transfer schedule, transaction confirmations
5 · Fulfil your first	"Am I ready to use my investment?"	Review the amount available and request redemption when needed, allowing for settlement. If the amount falls short or the goal changes, revise the plan. The goal date does not trigger an assumed success or a compulsory withdrawal.	Goal review, redemption flow, completion acknowledgement
6 · Name your next first	"What comes next?"	Keep the account, choose another goal and confirm a new contribution plan. Suitability and the allocation are reassessed for the new timeline.	Next-goal invitation, saved account details, new plan confirmation

THE PLATFORM DECISION

The account and the plan live in the BPI App (proposed entry point, subject to confirmation). The saver is already verified, so opening is a confirmation, not an application; the salary usually lands in the same bank, which makes payday a natural trigger. Suitability, statements and withdrawals stay under one regulated roof, and the optional glide path needs two funds (growth and lower-risk) that BPI already runs. All Firsts Fund screens are new and labelled proposed.

HOW MONEY GOES IN

At launch: a regular monthly plan plus top-ups whenever you like. Either one alone keeps a goal on track.

Missed month (not enough money, or skipped): the goal date stays the same unless the saver changes it. The app shows the updated projection and offers a one-off top-up, a higher amount from now on, or a later date. Debits are never raised automatically.

Sukli: a future enhancement. Spare change from purchases set aside and invested at ₱100. It starts inside the BPI App to prove it works, before any e-wallet. Still to settle: which purchases count, consent, where the change waits, and when it moves. Spend-only, a balance floor, a monthly cap and one-tap off are the intended guardrails.

THE DESIGN CONSTITUTION: WE OPTIMISE AGAINST ENGAGEMENT

Apps chase daily users. A fund whose aim is that people keep contributing should do the opposite, because checking the balance comes before selling.

1	No daily balance notification. Ever.
2	The main screen shows goal progress: total put in, current value and gain or loss, in pesos.
3	Notifications follow payday and the goal date, never the price.
4	Checking the balance is one tap further than adding to it.
5	No streaks. Missing a month should never feel like losing.

Details view: units, price per unit and every transaction. **Reports:** in-app progress, periodic summaries, transaction confirmations, and fund reports at least quarterly.

THE OPTIONAL GLIDE PATH: WHY AND HOW, IN SIMPLE WORDS

Why. Near the goal date there is no time left to recover from a fall, and the fund cannot slow down for one person. **How.** In the saver's own account, not the fund. Explained at plan set-up (stage 3); savers who enroll give standing authorization for part of their units to move to a lower-risk BPI fund as the date nears. Nothing moves for anyone else; it lowers risk but does not guarantee the goal. In Bea's plan over 36 years of history, the weakest outcome improves from ₱77,000 to ₱104,000. A proposed platform feature that still needs operational checks.

THE WITHDRAWAL SCREEN: WHERE FUNDS LOSE PEOPLE

WITHDRAW · CONFIRM (proposed screen, example numbers)

₱26,500

You have put in ₱28,000 over 14 months; it is worth ₱26,500 today. You are ₱93,500 from your first: Japan with your parents, October 2031.

[Pause the plan for 3 months] Withdraw ₱26,500

Pausing comes first; withdrawing stays one tap away, with settlement time shown. No holding period or exit fee, and the goal date never forces a withdrawal. The manager sees goal dates ahead and keeps about 3% cash for withdrawals.

HOW WE WOULD KNOW IT WORKED

Measure	Target	Rethink if
Still contributing in month 60	≥ 55%	< 40%
Kept contributing through the first losing quarter	≥ 80%	< 60%
Chose "pause" over "withdraw"	≥ 3 to 1	< 1 to 1
Months contributed in year 1 (median)	≥ 10 of 12	< 7
Reached a first and named the next one	tracked	

Not counted as success: money gathered, accounts opened or app visits.

IMPORTANT. A FinQuest 2026 student proposal: not an offer or investment advice and not a BPI Wealth product. Performance figures are backtested with hindsight. Screens and examples are proposed and illustrative. Full disclosures: Fund Fact Sheet and Annex.

FUND OBJECTIVE AND THEME

Theme: global real capacity. Businesses providing essential services and infrastructure that are hard to replace, because they take licences, decades and large capital to build: power and water, phone and internet networks, ports, airports, hospitals, and the equipment they run on.

Objective. Long-term capital growth by investing directly in these businesses, listed around the world.

How the fund invests, in one line. We identify businesses providing essential services and infrastructure, check their financial strength and value, and build a portfolio that balances opportunities with risk. How many companies we hold follows from that process. The fund is **actively managed with diversification and risk controls**; the manager may change holdings and weights within the mandate.

Why it exists. An early-career Filipino earns and saves in pesos, so their future depends on one economy. Firsts Fund would let them own a share of essential businesses around the world from ₱100, in pesos, through a fund that holds the shares directly with a single fee.

Suitable investor. Regular income, a goal at least **five years** away, and the risk tolerance for an equity fund that can fall sharply in a bad year. Not suitable for money needed within five years or for emergency savings.

Optional glide path (proposed, in the investor's own account). Close to a goal date there is little time to recover from a fall. Investors who enroll when setting up their plan give standing authorization to move part of their units to a lower-risk fund as the date nears. Nothing moves for those who do not enroll; it changes only their account, not how this fund invests; units are sold at that day's price, and the goal is not guaranteed.

For a regular saver (illustration, not a forecast). ₱1,000 a month for 5 years is ₱60,000 paid in. Across every 5-year stretch from 1990 to 2026 in the industry-level history (381 start months), the typical saver ended with about **₱80,000**. About 1 in 9 stretches ended below ₱60,000; the worst, ending in early 2009, at about ₱39,000. With the optional glide path, the worst was about ₱52,000.
Same fee and costs; contributions at the start of each month. It reflects the theme, not our company choices.

KEY FACTS

Theme	Global real capacity
Structure	Global equity UITF (proposed)
Currency	Philippine peso; daily NAVPU
Horizon	5 years or longer
Risk classification	Aggressive
Minimum (proposed)	₱100 to start and per top-up
Fee (proposed)	1.50% a year
All-in cost (est.)	about 2.1% a year, all costs
Buy or sell (proposed)	Any business day; paid T+5; no exit fee
Holdings	31 listed companies, 14 markets
Cash	About 3%, kept to pay redemptions
Limit per company	20% (BSP rule); largest today 5.8%
Benchmark	NFRA global infrastructure ETF, in pesos
Reviews	Holdings monthly; weights quarterly
Trustee	BPI Wealth (proposed)

ALLOCATION BY TYPE OF ESSENTIAL SERVICE

Digital networks	25.00%
Healthcare facilities	22.19%
Power generation & grids	19.22%
Ports	10.04%
Semiconductors	8.13%
Water	7.68%
Grid & power equipment	2.76%
Airports & toll roads	1.98%
Operating cash	3.00%

By listing market	
United States	22.96%
Hong Kong / China	10.98%
Saudi Arabia	10.91%
Germany	8.44%
Thailand	7.28%
Japan	5.56%
Malaysia	5.23%
Philippines	4.80%
6 other markets	20.84%

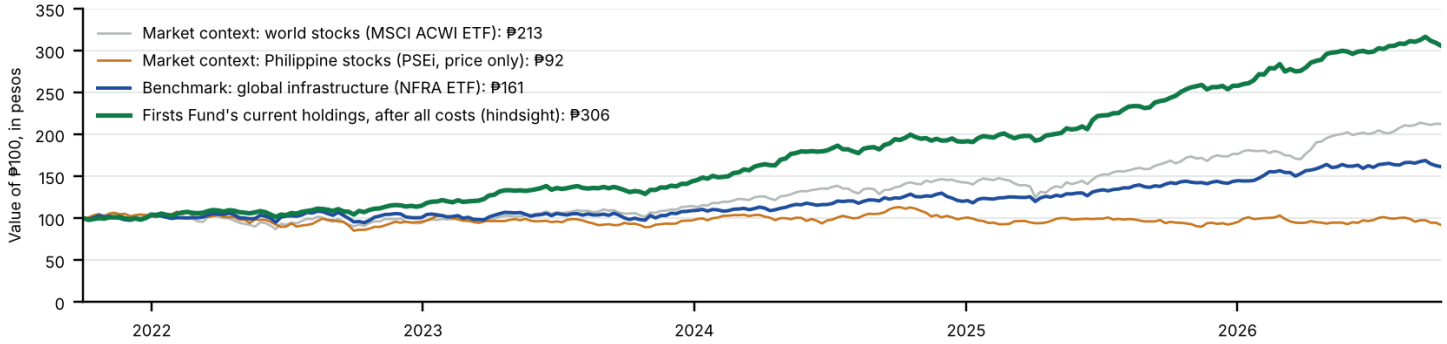
Largest holdings. Exelon 5.8%, Westports 5.2%, ICTSI 4.8%, Engie 4.6%, Bangkok Dusit Medical 4.5%. No company is above 5.8%; all 31 are listed on page 5.

No country quota. Philippine-listed ICTSI is held at 4.80% because it passed the same tests as every other company. Where a company is listed is not always where it earns its revenue.

Shared drivers. About 11% depends on data-centre spending (chips and grid equipment). Digital networks are at the fund's 25% limit per type of service.

PERFORMANCE VS BENCHMARK · PAST RETURNS OF TODAY'S HOLDINGS, IN PESOS · NOT ACTUAL FUND PERFORMANCE

₱100 invested in October 2021 → ₱306 for today's holdings after all costs, vs **₱161** for the benchmark: **25.0%** vs **10.0%** a year. **Hindsight:** these companies were chosen in October 2026, so this is not a forecast.



In pesos	2021*	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026*	A year	Volatility	Worst fall
Firsts Fund holdings, after costs	**+3.8%**	**+10.6%**	**+25.4%**	**+32.9%**	**+34.9%**	**+18.5%**	**+25.0%**	**10.2%**	**−7.4%**
Benchmark: NFRA infrastructure ETF	+3.1%	−2.4%	+8.3%	+10.2%	+19.8%	+12.2%	+10.0%	12.4%	−12.6%
Market context: world (MSCI ACWI ETF)	+6.3%	−11.4%	+21.5%	+24.7%	+23.7%	+20.2%	+16.2%	14.8%	−18.2%
Market context: Philippines (PSEi)	+2.7%	−6.8%	+1.7%	+2.8%	−6.3%	−2.0%	−1.7%	13.7%	−21.1%

Also, today's holdings over 5 years: last year +25.4%; last 3 years +32.6% a year · worst 12 months +4.3%, best +52.7% · return for each unit of ups and downs (Sharpe ratio) 2.00 vs 0.45 for the benchmark · moved about 0.59× as much as the benchmark (beta). **In pesos:** the deepest drop on a ₱5,000 balance was ₱372; a bad year like the 36-year worst (−27%) would be ₱1,363.

How to read this. These are past returns of the 31 companies we hold today, after the 1.50% fee, trading costs and dividend taxes; because they were picked knowing how they did, the fund's real results would likely be lower. **Without the 7 chip and grid-equipment companies**, the other 24 returned 18.7% a year (₱100 → ₱237), so the lead over the benchmark does not rest on them alone. **Over the long run:** an industry-level version of the strategy returned 12.0% a year from 1990 to 2026, about the same as the world market (12.2%), with a worst 12 months of −27%. Benchmark and references are ETFs after their own fees. *2021 from 1 Oct; 2026 to 2 Oct.

IMPORTANT. Firsts Fund is a student competition proposal; no such fund exists and nothing here is an offer, solicitation or investment advice. Simulated and historical figures do not represent actual trading. The value of units can fall as well as rise and an investor may get back less than invested. A UITF is not a deposit and is not insured by PDIC.

ALL 31 HOLDINGS · WEIGHTED SO EACH COMPANY ADDS A SIMILAR SHARE OF RISK · AS OF 2 OCTOBER 2026

Holding		Essential service	Weight	% of risk
Exelon	US	Power & grids	5.81%	3.9%
Westports	MY	Ports	5.23%	3.8%
ICTSI	PH	Ports	4.80%	3.6%
Engie	FR	Power & grids	4.57%	3.7%
Bangkok Dusit Medical	TH	Healthcare facilities	4.49%	3.6%
E.ON	DE	Power & grids	4.48%	3.7%
Dr. Sulaiman Al Habib	SA	Healthcare facilities	4.41%	3.7%
Guangdong Investment	HK	Water	4.36%	3.7%
KDDI	JP	Digital networks	3.81%	1.8%
Encompass Health	US	Healthcare facilities	3.78%	3.8%
AT&T	US	Digital networks	3.77%	2.3%
Mouwasat Medical Services	SA	Healthcare facilities	3.52%	3.7%
China Telecom	HK	Digital networks	3.33%	2.6%
Sabesp	BR	Water	3.31%	3.6%
China Mobile	HK	Digital networks	3.29%	2.0%
HCA Healthcare	US	Healthcare facilities	3.19%	3.6%

Holding		Essential service	Weight	% of risk
Enel	IT	Power & grids	2.98%	3.6%
Saudi Telecom	SA	Digital networks	2.97%	1.9%
Bharti Airtel	IN	Digital networks	2.97%	2.4%
Deutsche Telekom	DE	Digital networks	2.85%	2.4%
Bumrungrad Hospital	TH	Healthcare facilities	2.79%	3.5%
Qualcomm	US	Semiconductors	2.27%	3.5%
América Móvil	MX	Digital networks	2.01%	2.6%
OMA (airports)	MX	Airports & toll roads	1.98%	3.5%
Advantest	JP	Semiconductors	1.74%	3.4%
HD Hyundai Electric	KR	Grid & power equipment	1.65%	3.4%
NVIDIA	US	Semiconductors	1.64%	3.4%
Vistra	US	Power & grids	1.38%	3.4%
SK hynix	KR	Semiconductors	1.37%	3.4%
Micron	US	Semiconductors	1.12%	3.3%
Siemens Energy	DE	Grid & power equipment	1.11%	3.4%

Read the risk column, not the weight column. Weights run from 1.1% to 5.8%, but the 23 holdings outside the capped digital networks each carry a similar 3.3%–3.9% of risk: that is the design. NVIDIA gets 1.6% because it swings far more than a hospital operator. The 8 network companies carry less (1.8%–2.6%) because their kind is at the 25% cap. Chips are 8% of the money and 17% of the risk. Together they behave like about 9 independent groups. Weights are reset quarterly; companies we rejected or are watching are in the supporting proposal.

M · V · P: HOW WE BUILD THE PORTFOLIO · 140 COMPANIES SCREENED → 31 HELD · THE SAME PUBLISHED RULES FOR EVERY COMPANY

M — Map the milestone

Start from what a saver's firsts depend on (power, water, connectivity, transport, health care) and find the businesses providing those essential services and infrastructure: up to the 20 largest listed in each of eight kinds, anywhere in the world, each worth at least US$1 billion (about ₱62 billion). Keep those earning at least half their revenue there and generating cash.

140 → 129
140 screened · 129 fit the theme

V — Verify the investment

Check each company is a sound investment: survives a debt stress test sized to its industry, and compares well with its own peers on price and quality; tradeable; sound governance.

129 → 49
49 eligible · 35 rejected · 45 on watch

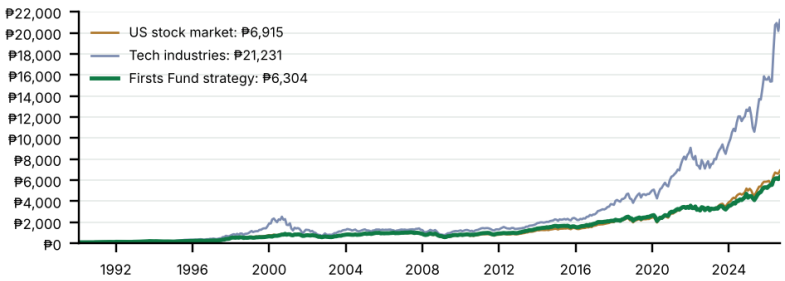
P — Position the risk

Add eligible companies in merit order, only if each one improves diversification. Size them so every holding adds a similar share of risk, within limits: 20% per company or group, 25% per kind of service, about 3% cash.

49 → 31
31 held · 18 on watch (added too little diversification)

Judgement sits in the published rules, not in picking favourites. Holdings are reviewed monthly and may be removed after a material event (with the reason logged), but are never resized by hand; weights are reset quarterly. Every company's result is in the supporting proposal.

36 YEARS OF HISTORY · INDUSTRY-LEVEL VERSION OF THE STRATEGY, IN PESOS · CONTEXT, NOT THE FUND'S RESULTS



In pesos, 1990–2026	Strategy	Market	Tech
₱100 in Jan 1990 became	₱6,304	₱6,915	₱21,231
A year	12.0%	12.2%	15.7%
Deepest fall	−44%	−47%	−73%
Worst 12 months	−27%	−30%	−58%
Months to recover	69	72	192
Dot-com	−10%	−27%	−70%
Global financial crisis	−40%	−44%	−45%
COVID	−9%	−4%	+5%
2022 rate shock	−12%	−13%	−21%

The same kinds of businesses (utilities, telecoms, transport, health care, electrical equipment and chips), tracked as US industry groups from 1990 to August 2026 after the 1.50% fee, converted to pesos. It does not use our 31 companies, so it shows how the theme behaves through crises, not a forecast: about the market's return (12.0% vs 12.2% a year) with somewhat shallower falls. Last four rows: change during each crisis. Source: Kenneth French Data Library; BIS exchange rates.

KEY RISKS

Market	Share prices can fall sharply. In 36 years of industry-level history the worst 12 months lost 27% and the deepest fall was 44%.
Concentration	Digital networks are at the fund's 25% cap; data-centre spending drives about 11% of the fund but more of its past return (memory-chip makers are near a cyclical peak); Saudi Arabia 11% and US health policy about 7%.
Currency	About 92% is in foreign currencies and not hedged; a stronger peso lowers returns in pesos.
Liquidity	Each holding is kept small enough to sell within a week without moving its price much (sized for a ₱1bn fund), and about 3% is kept in cash. Many goals may fall due on the same dates (for example December); the manager sees goal dates in advance and can raise cash early.
Country and regulation	Companies in emerging markets, including some partly owned by governments, face policy and sanctions risk.
Selection	Companies are screened with one data provider and thresholds set by the team; the past results shown include hindsight.

FEES AND CHARGES

Management fee (proposed)	1.50% a year of fund value, accrued daily
Trading costs (modelled)	about 0.21% a year
Dividend withholding (modelled)	about 0.37% a year
Subscription / redemption fee	None proposed
Minimum holding period	None proposed; 5 years+ is a recommendation
Estimated all-in cost	**about 2.1% a year**

SUBSCRIPTIONS AND REDEMPTIONS (PROPOSED)

Buy units with a one-time amount, a regular monthly plan, or top-ups whenever you like. Sell on any business day at that day's price per unit (NAVPU); the money is paid on day 6, end of day, in line with BPI's peso global equity funds. A missed monthly contribution does not change your goal date and is not taken automatically later.

Compared with other products a young Filipino can buy today: see page 1.

Sources. Company data: stockanalysis.com (S&P Global Market Intelligence), 8 Oct 2026. Prices: Yahoo Finance total returns and PSE Edge (with cash dividends), converted to pesos weekly. Benchmark: Northern Trust (formerly FlexShares) STOXX Global Broad Infrastructure ETF (NFRA), Yahoo Finance adjusted close in pesos; cross-check iShares Global Infrastructure ETF (IGF) returned 13.7% a year. Cash: BSP policy rate minus 0.50 pt. Industry-level history: Kenneth French Data Library and BIS exchange rates. Single-company limit: BSP Circular No. 1234, Series of 2026 (20 May 2026), a 20% ceiling, not a target. Comparison funds: BPI Wealth fund pages and Pag-IBIG. Industry classifications assigned by the team. Dividend tax rates approximate, to be confirmed.

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A1 · WHAT CHANGED AFTER THE BPI CONSULTATIONS

Horizon	Five years or longer throughout; a recommendation, not a lock-in or a promise of returns.
Theme	Global real capacity, defined as businesses providing essential services and infrastructure; no blanket "non-tech" claim; technology exposure assessed.
Selection	M · V · P kept: Map the milestone, Verify the investment, Position the risk.
Holdings	The earlier 16 was not retained; the holdings review under the current rules gives 31.
Philippine share	The fixed 30% Philippines / 70% global split was dropped; countries follow from the same tests.
Benchmark	NFRA global infrastructure ETF in pesos; world and Philippine indices shown as market context only.
Performance	Labelled as backtested, never as actual fund results; calendar years and balanced risk shown.
Persona and goals	Early-career saver; one main first; "Help me choose my first"; several firsts later.
Calculator	Contributions-only plus an illustrative scenario, optional inflation, assumptions visible.
Contributions	Monthly plan plus top-ups at launch; Sukli a future enhancement, starting in the BPI App.
Missed months	Goal date unchanged; user chooses a top-up, a higher amount or a later date; no automatic increase.
Dashboard	Contributions, value, gain or loss, goal progress; no streaks.
Risk messaging	No "bad year first" step; clear risk information before committing, balanced scenarios.
Customer journey	Six stages: discover, name, take the first step, manage, fulfil, name the next first.
Glide path	Optional, account-level, explained at plan set-up; enrolled savers give standing authorization.
Redemption	Goal date never forces a withdrawal or assumes success; shortfall or new goal means revising the plan.
Marketing	One message, "Fund your firsts"; talks, caravans, campus and workplaces first; no raffles at launch.
Structure and platform	A peso global UITF; the BPI App as the proposed entry point; new screens labelled proposed.

A2 · STILL TO BE VALIDATED

Glide path	Moving units to a lower-risk fund for one saver needs operational checks; it is not promised as automatic.
Sukli	Which purchases count, consent, where spare change waits, and when it moves; BPI App first.
Running costs	Custody, currency and audit costs of holding foreign shares directly; the fund needs seed money and a minimum size.
Dividend taxes	Rates are approximate; to be confirmed by a tax adviser.
Staying power	How many savers keep contributing through a losing year; the first thing to test with real data.

A3 · BACK-TEST METHOD AND ITS LIMITS

Method. Weekly peso returns including dividends, 1 Oct 2021 – 2 Oct 2026. Each quarter, weights were set using only the previous three years of prices, under every limit (21 times). After the 1.50% fee, 0.30% trading cost and dividend taxes. Benchmark NFRA, in pesos.

Selection is hindsight	Companies chosen in Oct 2026 with Oct 2026 data, priced backwards. Upper bound.
Survivorship	Universe is today's largest companies; failures since 2021 are missing.
One cycle	Chips are 8% of the money but 17% of the risk, near a cyclical peak; without chips and grid equipment, 18.7% a year.
Tax estimate	Dividend tax rates are approximate; to be confirmed by a tax adviser.

The first three make the figures look better than reality. We do not adjust for them; the 36-year industry history is our "what to expect". Withdrawals and goal-service moves are ordinary sales of units, paid from cash first and then by selling shares, at the 0.30% trading cost.

A4 · LIMITS: RULE VS TODAY (ALL MET AT EVERY QUARTERLY RESET)

Limit	Rule	Actual
One company	≤ 20% (BSP)	5.81%
One group (e.g. Razon)	≤ 20%	4.80%
One type of service	≤ 25%	25.00%
Liquidity	sell in 5 days at 20% of volume	never binds at ₱1bn
Operating cash	about 3%	3.00%
Country quota	none	Philippines 4.80% (3.2%–5.3%)

Concentration, disclosed: the 31 holdings behave like about 9 independent groups; the two biggest common influences explain 25% of the ups and downs. Holdings outside the capped networks each carry 3.3–3.9% of the risk.

A5 · REGULATORY POSITION

The fund. A peso UITF holding foreign shares directly, priced daily (NAVPU), with a 20% single-company ceiling per BSP Circular No. 1234 (2026). Our reading, not reviewed by counsel; any launch would need that review first.

Suitability. The standard BPI suitability assessment applies unchanged. The saver's goal and date are recorded with their plan; goals under five years are pointed to lower-risk options.

Sukli (future). Starts inside the BPI App. Needs clear, revocable consent, rules on which purchases count, and a regulated place for spare change to wait before it is invested; e-wallets only after that works and partner agreements exist.

Reports. Separate in-app progress view, transaction statements, and fund disclosures, with fund reports at least quarterly.

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